Sequence

A function: $\mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{R}$, $n \mapsto f(n) = x_n$

Denoted: $\{x_n\}_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$, $\{x_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$, $\{x_n\}$

Def 2.1: Convergence:

A sequence $\{x_n\}$ converges to $a \in \mathbb{R}$ if for any $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$n \geq N \Rightarrow |x_n - a| < \varepsilon$

"$\forall \varepsilon > 0,\ \exists N \in \mathbb{N}:\ n \geq N \Rightarrow |x_n - a| < \varepsilon$"

We write: $x_n \to a$ or $\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = a$.

$x_n \to a \Leftrightarrow x_n - a \to 0 \Leftrightarrow |x_n - a| \to 0$

pf: pf: pf:

Ex. Suppose $x_n = c$ for some $c \in \mathbb{R}$. Prove that $\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = c$.

pf: need N such that $\forall n \geq N$, $|x_n - c| < \varepsilon$.
$|x_n - c| = |c - c| = 0 < \varepsilon$ ✓ (any N works)

∴ Since $\varepsilon > 0$ was arbitrary, $\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = c$.

(Or: given $\varepsilon > 0$, choose $N = 1$. Then $n \geq N \Rightarrow |x_n - c| = 0 < \varepsilon$.)

Ex. Prove that $\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{3n+1}{2n} = \frac{3}{2}$.

pf: need N such that $\forall n \geq N$, $\left|\frac{3n+1}{2n} - \frac{3}{2}\right| < \varepsilon$.

$\left|\frac{3n+1}{2n} - \frac{3}{2}\right| = \left|\frac{2(3n+1) - 3(2n)}{4n}\right| = \left|\frac{2}{4n}\right| = \frac{1}{2n} < \varepsilon$ ✓ (Archimedean property)

∴ Since $\varepsilon > 0$ was arbitrary, such N exists.

(Or: given $\varepsilon > 0$, choose $N = \left\lceil \frac{1}{2\varepsilon} \right\rceil$. Then $n \geq N \Rightarrow \left|\frac{3n+1}{2n} - \frac{3}{2}\right| = \frac{1}{2n} \leq \frac{1}{2N} < \varepsilon$.)

Such that $\left|\frac{3n+1}{2n} - \frac{3}{2}\right| < \frac{1}{2N} < \varepsilon$, $\left|\frac{3n+1}{2n} - \frac{3}{2}\right| < \frac{1}{2n} < \varepsilon$.

Ex. Prove $\lim_{n\to\infty} c = c$.

pf: Let $\varepsilon > 0$. Choose $N = 1$. Then $n \geq N \Rightarrow |x_n - c| = |c - c| = 0 < \varepsilon$.

∴ $\lim_{n\to\infty} c = c$.

Ex. Prove $\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1}{n} = 0$.

pf: Let $\varepsilon > 0$. Choose $N = \left\lceil \frac{1}{\varepsilon} \right\rceil$. Then $n \geq N \Rightarrow \left|\frac{1}{n} - 0\right| = \frac{1}{n} \leq \frac{1}{N} < \varepsilon$.

∴ $\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1}{n} = 0$.

Ex. Prove $\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1}{n^2} = 0$.

pf: Let $\varepsilon > 0$. Choose $N = \left\lceil \frac{1}{\sqrt{\varepsilon}} \right\rceil$. Then $n \geq N \Rightarrow \left|\frac{1}{n^2} - 0\right| = \frac{1}{n^2} \leq \frac{1}{N^2} < \varepsilon$.

∴ $\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1}{n^2} = 0$.

Ex. Prove $\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{n^2+n+1}{1+2n^2} = \frac{1}{2}$.

By definition of limit, we can prove $\frac{1}{2} \neq a$, $\forall a \in \mathbb{R}$ or $a = \infty$.

$\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{n^2+n+1}{1+2n^2} = \lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1+\frac{1}{n}+\frac{1}{n^2}}{\frac{1}{n^2}+2} = \frac{1+0+0}{0+2} = \frac{1}{2}$.

Definition 2.14: infinite limits

Let $\{x_n\}$ be a real sequence.

(i) We write $x_n \to +\infty$ if, for every $M \in \mathbb{R}$, there is $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that
$n \geq N \Rightarrow x_n > M$

(ii) We write $x_n \to -\infty$ if, for every $M \in \mathbb{R}$, there is $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that
$n \geq N \Rightarrow x_n < M$

In either case the sequence diverges in $\mathbb{R}$, although it has a limit in the extended real line.

Unbounded sets contain divergent sequences

Let $E \subseteq \mathbb{R}$.
(i) If $\sup E = +\infty$, there is a sequence $\{x_n\} \subseteq E$ such that $x_n \to +\infty$.
(ii) If $\inf E = -\infty$, there is a sequence $\{y_n\} \subseteq E$ such that $y_n \to -\infty$.

proof: (i) If $\sup E = +\infty$, E is unbounded above.

For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, choose $x_n \in E$ such that $x_n > n$.

Given $M \in \mathbb{R}$, choose $N > M$. For $n \geq N$

$x_n > n \geq N > M$

By def: $\forall M,\ x_n \to \infty$ as $n \to \infty$.

(ii) $\inf E = -\infty$ Choose $x_n < -n$

$x_n < -n < -M$ ∴ $x_n \to -\infty$ as $n \to \infty$

The extended real number

Define: $\overline{\mathbb{R}} = \mathbb{R} \cup \{-\infty, +\infty\}$

For $\emptyset \neq E \subseteq \mathbb{R}$: $\sup E = +\infty$ if E is unbounded above; $\inf E = -\infty$ if E is unbounded below.

For $E = \emptyset$: $\sup E = -\infty$, $\inf E = +\infty$.

Theorem 2.15: arithmetic with infinite limits

Suppose that $x_n \to +\infty$; the corresponding conclusions for $x_n \to -\infty$ are shown in parentheses.

(i) If $\{y_n\}$ is bounded below (respectively, bounded above), then
$\frac{\text{finite}}{\infty} \to 0$
$x_n + y_n \to +\infty$ (respectively, $x_n + y_n \to -\infty$).

(ii) If $y_n \geq M_0$ for some $M_0 > 0$ and every n, then
$x_n y_n \to +\infty$ (respectively, $x_n y_n \to -\infty$).

(iii) If $\{y_n\}$ is bounded and $x_n \neq 0$ for every n, then
$\frac{y_n}{x_n} \to 0$.

proof: (i) Suppose $y_n \geq k$ for all n. Given $K \in \mathbb{R}$

$x_n + y_n \geq x_n + k > K$ ∀ $M \in \mathbb{R}$, $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}$.
$n > N \Rightarrow x_n > M - k$
$y_n \geq k$ for all n
$\Rightarrow x_n + y_n > M$.

(ii) $x_n y_n \geq x_n \cdot \frac{k}{M} = \frac{k}{M} x_n > K$ for any given $K \in \mathbb{R}$.
$n > N \Rightarrow x_n > \frac{M}{k}$
$\Rightarrow x_n y_n > K$ ∴ $x_n y_n \to +\infty$

(iii) $|x_n y_n| = |y_n| \cdot \frac{1}{|x_n|} > k \cdot \frac{1}{|x_n|} \to \infty$.
Since $|x_n| \to 0$.

(iv) y_n is bounded ⇒ $|y_n| < B$.
$x_n \to \infty$ ⇒ $|x_n| > \frac{k}{B}$ for any given $k \in \mathbb{R}$.
$|\frac{y_n}{x_n} - 0| < \frac{|y_n|}{|x_n|} < \frac{B}{|x_n|} < \frac{B}{k} \to 0$ ⇒ $\frac{y_n}{x_n} \to 0$.

The extended real line

Write

$$\overline{\mathbb{R}} := \mathbb{R} \cup \{-\infty, +\infty\}.$$

The following conventions are consistent with Theorem 2.15:

Addition	Multiplication
$x + (+\infty) = +\infty$	$x(+\infty) = +\infty$ if $x > 0$
$x + (-\infty) = -\infty$	$x(-\infty) = -\infty$ if $x > 0$
$(+\infty) + (+\infty) = +\infty$	$x(+\infty) = -\infty$ if $x < 0$
$(-\infty) + (-\infty) = -\infty$	$x(-\infty) = +\infty$ if $x < 0$
	$(+\infty)(+\infty) = (-\infty)(-\infty) = +\infty$
	$(+\infty)(-\infty) = (-\infty)(+\infty) = -\infty$

Indeterminate forms

Expressions such as

$$(+\infty) - (+\infty), \qquad \frac{\infty}{\infty}, \qquad 0 \cdot \infty$$

are not assigned values. Different sequences producing the same symbolic form can have different limits, so each case requires further analysis.

Corollary 2.16: extended-real limit arithmetic

Let $x_n \to a$ and $y_n \to y$, where $x, y \in \overline{\mathbb{R}}$.
(i) $x_n + y_n \to a + y$, provided $a + y$ is not of the form $(+\infty) + (-\infty)$.
(ii) For $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$, $\alpha x_n \to \alpha x$, provided the product is not of the form $0 \cdot (\pm\infty)$.
(iii) $x_n y_n \to xy$, provided the product is not of the form $0 \cdot (\pm\infty)$.

Theorem 2.17: comparison theorem

Suppose that $\{x_n\}$ and $\{y_n\}$ are convergent sequences. If there is $N_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$x_n \leq y_n \qquad (n \geq N_0),$$

then

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n \leq \lim_{n\to\infty} y_n.$$

In particular, if $x_n \in [r, s]$ for every n and $x_n \to c$, then $c \in [r, s]$.

proof: Suppose $x_n \to a$, $y_n \to b$, and $a > b$ by contradiction.

Let $\frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \frac{a-b}{2} > 0$

$\exists\ N_1, N_2 \in \mathbb{N}$. $n \geq N_1 \Rightarrow |x_n - a| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$
$n \geq N_2 \Rightarrow |y_n - b| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$

for $n \geq \max\{N_0, N_1, N_2\}$

$\frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \frac{a-b}{2} = (a - x_n) + (x_n - y_n) + (y_n - b)$
$< \frac{\varepsilon}{2} + 0 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \varepsilon$

Contradiction. Hence $a \leq b$.

Strict inequalities may disappear in the limit

Even if $x_n < y_n$ for every sufficiently large n, one can conclude only that

$\lim x_n \leq \lim y_n$. Can not Take over equality

not that the inequality between the limits is strict.

For example,

$$\frac{1}{n} < \frac{1}{n} + \frac{1}{n^2} \qquad (n \in \mathbb{N}),$$

but

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1}{n} = \lim_{n\to\infty} \left(\frac{1}{n} + \frac{1}{n^2}\right) = 0.$$

Definition 2.18: monotone sequences

Let $\{x_n\}$ be a sequence of real numbers.
(i) It is *increasing* if

$$x_1 \leq x_2 \leq x_3 \leq \cdots,$$

and *strictly increasing* if all these inequalities are strict.
(ii) It is *decreasing* if

$$x_1 \geq x_2 \geq x_3 \geq \cdots,$$

and *strictly decreasing* if all these inequalities are strict.
(iii) It is *monotone* if it is either increasing or decreasing.
Some authors use *nondecreasing* and *nonincreasing* for the two nonstrict notions.

If $\{x_n\}$ is increasing and $x_n \to a$, we write

$$x_n \nearrow a.$$

Similarly, $x_n \searrow a$ means that $\{x_n\}$ is decreasing and converges to a. Notice that

$$x_n \nearrow a \iff -x_n \searrow -a.$$

Theorem 2.19: monotone convergence theorem

If $\{x_n\}$ is increasing and bounded above, or decreasing and bounded below, then $\{x_n\}$ converges to a finite limit.

Proof: $E = \{x_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$. Since E is nonempty and bounded above.

By Completeness Theorem, $\exists\ a = \sup E \in \mathbb{R}$

$\forall\ \varepsilon > 0,\ \exists\ N \in \mathbb{N},\ a - \varepsilon < x_N \leq a$

For every $n \geq N$, $a - \varepsilon < x_N \leq x_n < a$.

$a - \varepsilon < x_n \leq a \Rightarrow |x_n - a| < \varepsilon$ for every $n \geq N$

Hence. $x_n \to a$.

ex. prove: if $|a| < 1$ then $a^n \to 0$

proof: let $x_n = |a|^n$ Since $|a| < 1$

then x_n is decreasing, and $x_n > 0 \Rightarrow x_n$ is bounded below

By thm if $\lim x_n$ for some $L \geq 0$.

Since $|a| \geq 0$, $\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = L$.

$\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} x_{n+1} \Rightarrow L = |a| L$.

Since $|a| \neq 0$ $L = 0$

$|a^n| \to 0 \Rightarrow a^n \to 0$

ex. $a > 0 \Rightarrow \sqrt[n]{a} \to 1$.

(1) if $a \geq 1$: $\sqrt[n]{a} \geq 1$ for all n.

(2) if $a < 1$: $\sqrt[n]{a} < 1$

Since $\frac{1}{a} > \frac{1}{a+1}$, x_n is decreasing

Since $\{x_n\}$ is bounded below.

$\Rightarrow \lim x_n = L$ for some $L \geq 1$

$\lim x_n = \lim x_{n+1} \Rightarrow L = \frac{1}{a+1} L \Rightarrow L = 1$

(3) if $0 < a < 1$. $\sqrt[n]{a} = \frac{1}{\sqrt[n]{1/a}} \to 1$ by (2)

Proof: $\lim \frac{a^{n+1}}{1+a^{n+1}} \cdot \frac{1}{a^n} = \frac{1}{2}$ By thm 2.13.

$\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{a^{n+1}}{1+a^{n+1}} \cdot \frac{1}{a^n} = \lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1+\frac{1}{a^{n+1}}}{\frac{1}{a^n}+3}$

By definition of limit. We can prove $\frac{1}{2} \neq a$, $\forall a \in \mathbb{R}$ or $a = \infty$.

$\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1+\frac{1}{a^{n+1}}}{\frac{1}{a^n}+3} = \lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1+0}{0+3} = \frac{1}{3} \neq \frac{1}{2}$.

Nested Interval

$\bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} I_n = [a, b]$ nonempty

$|I_n| \to 0 \Rightarrow \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} I_n = \{a\}$

Definition 2.22: nested sets

A sequence of sets $\{I_n\}_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ is nested if

$I_1 \supseteq I_2 \supseteq I_3 \supseteq \cdots$.

Theorem 2.23: nested interval property

Let $\{I_n\}$ be a nested sequence of nonempty, closed, bounded intervals. Then

$\exists\ a_n \in I_n$ for all n, $E = \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} I_n$ $\overset{a_n \in I_n}{\Rightarrow}$ $E \neq \emptyset$

is nonempty. If, in addition, the lengths satisfy $|I_n| \to 0$, then E consists of a single point.

Proof. Write

$I_n = [a_n, b_n]$.

The nesting condition implies

(1) $a_n \leq a_{n+1} \leq b_{n+1} \leq b_n$.

Then $\{a_n\}$ is increasing and bounded above by b_1, while $\{b_n\}$ is decreasing and bounded below by a_1. By Theorem 2.19, there are $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$ such that

$\lim_{n\to\infty} a_n = a$, $\lim_{n\to\infty} b_n = b$.

Fix n. For every $m \geq n$,

$a_n \leq a_m \leq b_m \leq b_n$.

Letting $m \to \infty$ gives

$a_n \leq a \leq b \leq b_n$.

Consequently $[a, b] \subseteq I_n$ for every n, and hence

$[a, b] \subseteq \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} I_n$.

In particular, the intersection is nonempty.

If $|I_n| = b_n - a_n \to 0$, then

$0 = \lim_{n\to\infty} (b_n - a_n) = b - a$,

so $a = b$. If $x \in E$, then $a_n \leq x \leq b_n$ for every n. Taking limits gives $a \leq x \leq b = a$, and therefore $x = a$. Thus $E = \{a\}$.

[a₁, b₁] ⊇ [a₂, b₂] ⊇ [a₃, b₃] ⊇ ⋯

$a_n < a_{n+1} < b_{n+1} < b_n$

$a_n < b_m$ for some m

$b_n > a_m$ for some m

$\Rightarrow \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} [a_n, b_n]$ is nonempty.

if $\lim a_n = b = a$. then $\forall\ x \in E$, $a_n \leq x \leq b_n$ ∴ Squeeze thm $\Rightarrow$ $x = a$

$a = b$

Bolzano-Weierstrass theorem

Every bounded sequence of real number has a convergent subsequence

proof: Let $\{x_n\}$ be a bounded sequence, say $\{x_n\} \subseteq [a, b]$

Cut by half

One of $[a, b]$ by half to get $[a, \frac{a+b}{2}]$, $[\frac{a+b}{2}, b]$

One of these two closed interval contains ∞ many x_n

Say that interval is $I_1 = [a_1, b_1]$

then $|I_1| = \frac{b-a}{2}$

$I_1 \supseteq I_2 \supseteq I_3 \supseteq \cdots$

Cut I_1 by half

One of these two closed interval contains ∞ many x_n

Say that interval is $I_2 = [a_2, b_2]$

then $|I_2| = \frac{b-a}{4}$

$I_2 \supseteq I_3 \supseteq I_4 \supseteq \cdots$

Continue in this fashion we get a nested sequence of closed interval

$I_n = [a_n, b_n]$ $|I_n| = \frac{b-a}{2^n} (b-a) \to 0$.

each I_n containing ∞ many x_n

$\bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} I_n = \{\alpha\}$

Now take one element $x_{n_1} \in I_1$, $n_1 \in \mathbb{N}$

$0 < |x_{n_1} - \alpha| < |I_1| = \frac{b-a}{2}$

$\Rightarrow 0$

The Squeeze theorem gives $x_{n_k} \to \alpha$

Monotone $x_n \uparrow a$. $x_n \downarrow a$

if $x_n \uparrow$ & x_n is bounded above ⇒ Converge to $\sup_n a$

BW Theorem

Bounded Seq has a Convergent Subseq

Comparison thm:

N_0 $n > N_0$: $x_n \leq y_n$

$\lim x_n \leq \lim y_n$

Skill

$x_n < y_n$

Convergent Seq has only 1 limit

Convergence

$\forall \varepsilon > 0,\ \exists N \in \mathbb{N}.\ n > N \Rightarrow |x_n - a| < \varepsilon$

$x_n \to a$

$\forall M \in \mathbb{R},\ \exists N \in \mathbb{N}.\ n > N \Rightarrow x_n > M$

$x_n \neq a$

$\exists \varepsilon > 0\ \forall N \in \mathbb{N}.\ n > N$ $|x_n - a| \geq \varepsilon$

Seq convergent ⇔ all Subseq convergent

Squeeze thm

1. $x_n \leq y_n \leq z_n$
2. $x_n \to a \Leftarrow z_n$
3. y_n bounded ⇒ $x_n y_n \to 0$

Converge ⇒ Bounded

Bounded ⇏ Converge ($\sin x$)

Arithmetic

$\lim x_n = a$, $\lim y_n = b$

$\lim (x_n + y_n) = a + b$

$\lim (x_n - y_n) = a - b$

$\lim (x_n y_n) = ab$

$\lim \frac{x_n}{y_n} = \frac{a}{b}$ $(b \neq 0)$

Limit Superior

$S_n = \sup\{x_k : k \geq n\}$

$t_n = \inf\{x_k : k \geq n\}$

$\Rightarrow$ $\lim_{n\to\infty} \sup x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} S_n$.

$\lim_{n\to\infty} \inf x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} t_n$

$S_{n+1} \leq S_n$

$t_{n+1} \geq t_n$

$t_n \leq S_n$

Inf / Sup

if has $\inf$ / $\sup$ (Can = $\pm\infty$)

has subseq ⇒ $\inf$ / $\sup$

Cauchy Seq

Def. $\forall \varepsilon > 0,\ \exists N \in \mathbb{N}.\ m, n > N \Rightarrow |x_m - x_n| < \varepsilon$

Cauchy Sequence

$\{x_n\}$ Cauchy ⇔ $\forall \varepsilon > 0\ \exists N \in \mathbb{N}.\ m, n > N \Rightarrow |x_m - x_n| < \varepsilon$.

Remark: if $\{x_n\}$ is Convergent then it is Cauchy

Theorem: $\{x_n\}$ is convergent ⇔ $\{x_n\}$ Cauchy

Suppose $\{x_n\}$ is Cauchy

① x_n is bounded ⇒ By BW theorem $\{x_n\}$ has convergent subseq $\{x_{n_k}\}$ converge to a.

② x_n is converge to a. Since $\{x_n\}$ is Cauchy

for $\varepsilon > 0$ $\exists N \in \mathbb{N}$ $m, n > N \Rightarrow |x_m - x_n| < \varepsilon$.

$\Rightarrow |x_m - x_{n_k}| < \varepsilon$ for any $m, n_k > N$

$|x_{n_k}| < |x_m| + \varepsilon$ for any $m, n_k > N$

Let $M = \max\{x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_{N-1}, |x_N| + \varepsilon\}$

$|x_n| < M$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ ∴ x_n is bounded

then B-W thm: x_n has a Convergent Subseq $\{x_{n_k}\}$

$x_{n_k} \to a$. $\forall \varepsilon > 0$, $\exists N_1$, $k > N_1 \Rightarrow |x_{n_k} - a| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$

Cauchy: $\exists N_2$ $m, n > N_2 \Rightarrow |x_m - x_n| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$

Let $N = \max\{N_1, N_2\}$

$n > N \Rightarrow |x_n - a| < |x_n - x_{n_k}| + |x_{n_k} - a| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2} + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \varepsilon$

$\Rightarrow$ Cauchy

if Cauchy $n, m > N$: $|x_m - x_n| < 1$.

fixed $n = N$. $\forall\ m > N$, $|x_m| < |x_N| + 1$

Let $M = \max\{x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_{N-1}, |x_N| + 1\}$

$|x_n| < M$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ ∴ x_n is bounded

then B-W thm: x_n has a Convergent Subseq $\{x_{n_k}\}$

$x_{n_k} \to a$. $\forall \varepsilon > 0$, $\exists N_1$, $k > N_1 \Rightarrow |x_{n_k} - a| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$

Cauchy: $\exists N_2$ $m, n > N_2 \Rightarrow |x_m - x_n| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$

Let $N = \max\{N_1, N_2\}$

$n > N \Rightarrow |x_n - a| < |x_n - x_{n_k}| + |x_{n_k} - a| < \varepsilon$

Let $P \geq N$ such that $n_P > N$

Then $\forall\ n > N$ we have

$|x_n - a| < |x_n - x_{n_P}| + |x_{n_P} - a| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2} + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \varepsilon$.

$\{x_n\}$: $|x_n - x_{n+1}| < \frac{1}{2^n}$ ∴ x_n is Convergent

$|x_n - x_{n+1}| = |x_n - x_{n+2} + x_{n+2} - x_{n+3} + \cdots + x_{n+1} - x_{n+1}|$

$\leq |x_n - x_{n+2}| + |x_{n+2} - x_{n+3}| + \cdots + |x_{n+1} - x_{n+1}|$

$< \frac{1}{2^{n+1}} + \frac{1}{2^{n+2}} + \cdots + \frac{1}{2^{2n}}$

$< \frac{1}{2^n}$

Remark: $\{x_n\}$ satisfying $|x_n - x_{n+1}| < \frac{1}{2^n}$ need not to be Cauchy

Ex: $\log n$

$|x_{n+1} - x_n| = \log(n+1) - \log n = \log\left(\frac{n+1}{n}\right) = \log\left(1 + \frac{1}{n}\right) < \frac{1}{n}$

However, Since $\{\log n$ doesn't converge. It is not Cauchy

Limit Superior & Inferior

$\{x_n\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$

$\lim_{n\to\infty} \sup x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} (\sup_{k\geq n} x_k)$

$\lim_{n\to\infty} \inf x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} (\inf_{k\geq n} x_k)$

Ex. $\{\frac{1}{n}\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$ $\begin{cases} \lim_{n\to\infty} \sup x_n = \sup_{k\geq n} \frac{1}{k} = \frac{1}{n} \\ \lim_{n\to\infty} \inf x_n = \inf_{k\geq n} \frac{1}{k} = 0 \end{cases}$

remark: if $A \neq \emptyset$. then

$\sup A < \sup B$, $\inf A < \inf B$

Since $\{x_k : k > n+1\} \subseteq \{x_k : k > n\}$

$\Rightarrow \sup_{k>n+1} S_n$ $\inf_{k>n+1} S_n \geq \inf_{k>n} S_n$

$\begin{cases} S_n \leq S_{n+1} \leq S_{n+2} \cdots \\ t_n < t_{n+1} < t_{n+2} \cdots \end{cases}$ $t_n \overset{\text{Sup}}{\leq} t_{n+1} \overset{\text{Sup}}{\leq} \cdots \overset{\text{Sup}}{\leq} S_{n+1} \overset{\text{Sup}}{\leq} S_n$

$\Rightarrow \lim_{n\to\infty} S_n = A$ (or ∞ if S_n is unbounded)

$\lim_{n\to\infty} t_n = b$ ($b \neq \infty$ if t_n is bounded)

Limit supremum/infimum:

$\begin{cases} \lim_{n\to\infty} \sup x_n := \lim_{n\to\infty} (\sup_{k\geq n} x_k) \\ \lim_{n\to\infty} \inf x_n := \lim_{n\to\infty} (\inf_{k\geq n} x_k) \end{cases}$

Ex. $x_n = (-1)^n$ $\sup_{k\geq n}\{(-1)^k, (-1)^{k+1}\} = 1$

$\begin{cases} \lim_{n\to\infty} \sup x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} (\sup_{k\geq n} (-1)^k) = 1 \\ \lim_{n\to\infty} \inf x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} (\inf_{k\geq n} (-1)^k) = -1 \end{cases}$

Ex. $x_n = 1 + 1/n$.

$\begin{cases} \lim_{n\to\infty} \sup x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} (\sup_{k\geq n} (1 + \frac{1}{k})) = \lim_{n\to\infty} (1 + \frac{1}{n}) = 1. \\ \lim_{n\to\infty} \inf x_n = \lim_{n\to\infty} (\inf_{k\geq n} (1 + \frac{1}{k})) = \lim_{n\to\infty} 1 = 1. \end{cases}$

Thm: Suppose $\{x_n\}$ is a bounded Sequence

$\lim_{n\to\infty} \sup x_n = a \in \mathbb{R}$ $\lim_{n\to\infty} \inf x_n = b \in \mathbb{R}$

(1) if $\forall \varepsilon > 0$, $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}$, then $b - \varepsilon < x_n < a + \varepsilon$ proof: $r_1 < x_n < r_2$ $\forall\ n \in \mathbb{N}$.

(2) $\exists$ Subsequence $\{x_{n_k}\}, \{x_{m_k}\}$ such that

$\lim_{k\to\infty} x_{n_k} = a$ $\lim_{k\to\infty} x_{m_k} = b$

proof: Since $\lim_{n\to\infty} \sup x_n = a$.

$S_n = \sup\{x_k : k > n\}$. $S_n \searrow a$.

For $n = 1$: $S_1 = \sup_{k>1}\{x_k\}$, $\exists\ n_1 > 1$, $x_{n_1} > S_1 - 1$.

$\exists\ n_2 > n_1 + 1$ $S_{n_1+1} - \frac{1}{2} < x_{n_2} < S_{n_1+1}$

$\exists\ n_3 > n_2 + 1$ $S_{n_2+1} - \frac{1}{3} < x_{n_3} < S_{n_2+1}$

$\cdots$

$S_{n_{k+1}} - \frac{1}{k} < x_{n_k} < S_{n_{k-1}+1}$, $\forall\ k \in \mathbb{N}$

$k \to \infty$. $\lim_{k\to\infty} S_{n_k} = a$ $\Rightarrow S_{n_k+1} \to a$ as $k \to \infty$.

Squeeze thm: $\lim_{k\to\infty} x_{n_k} = a$

(3) if $\{x_{n_k}\}$ is a convergent subsequence of $\{x_n\}$

Then $b \leq \lim_{k\to\infty} x_{n_k} \leq a$

proof: Suppose $\lim_{k\to\infty} x_{n_k} > a$. $\exists\ \varepsilon = \frac{\lim x_{n_k} - a}{2} > 0$

$\forall\ N, k \in \mathbb{N}$. $\exists\ n_k > N$, $k \geq N \Rightarrow n_k \geq N$

$\Rightarrow \inf\{x_k : k \geq N\} \leq x_{n_k} < \sup\{x_k : k \geq N\}$ $\forall\ k \geq N$

$\Rightarrow \inf\{x_k : k \geq N\} \geq \lim_{k\to\infty} x_{n_k} > \sup\{x_k : k \geq N\}$

$\Rightarrow$ $\sup\{x_k : k \geq N\}$ $\inf\{x_k : k \geq N\}$ $k \to \infty$, $N \to \infty$

$b \leq x \leq a$

(4) The sequence $\{x_n\}$ converges to $a = b$.

1. $x_n \to x \Rightarrow x_{n_k} \to x \Rightarrow a = b = x$
2. if $a > b$: $\exists\ n \geq N$ $x_n < \sup\{x_k : k \geq N\}$ $\inf\{x_k : k \geq N\} < x_n$

Monotone Convergence Theorem

Every bounded monotone sequence is convergent.

Proof: Suppose $\{x_n\}$ is increasing and bounded above.

Let $S = \sup\{x_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$. Then $x_n \leq S$ for all n.

Given $\varepsilon > 0$, $S - \varepsilon$ is not an upper bound of $\{x_n\}$.

So there exists $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $x_N > S - \varepsilon$.

Since $\{x_n\}$ is increasing, $x_n \geq x_N$ for all $n \geq N$.

Therefore $S - \varepsilon < x_n \leq S < S + \varepsilon$ for all $n \geq N$.

Hence $|x_n - S| < \varepsilon$.

Thus $\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = S$.

If $\{x_n\}$ is decreasing and bounded below, then $\{-x_n\}$ is increasing and bounded above, so $\lim_{n\to\infty} (-x_n) = \sup\{-x_n\}$.

Therefore $\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = \inf\{x_n\}$.

Exercise 1.

If $\lim_{n\to\infty} a_n = a$, then

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{a_1 + a_2 + \cdots + a_n}{n} = a.$$

if $a = 0$: Since $\lim_{n\to\infty} a_n = a$. $\forall\ \varepsilon > 0\ \exists N \in \mathbb{N}$. $n > N \Rightarrow |a_n| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$.

Let $S_N = \sum_{n=1}^{N} a_n$. $\exists\ n_0 \in \mathbb{N}$. $n > n_0 \Rightarrow \frac{S_N}{n} < \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$.

for N, n fixed, $n > N$:

$\frac{a_1 + a_2 + \cdots + a_n}{n} = \frac{S_N}{n} + \frac{a_{N+1} + \cdots + a_n}{n}$

$|\cdots| < |\frac{S_N}{n}| + |\frac{a_{N+1} + \cdots + a_n}{n}| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2} + \frac{(n-N)\varepsilon}{2n} < \frac{\varepsilon}{2} + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \varepsilon$.

$\frac{a_1 + a_2 + \cdots + a_n}{n} \to a$ as $n \to \infty$.

for general Case: $a \neq 0$.

Let $b_n = a_n - a$ $\lim_{n\to\infty} b_n = 0$, as Shown above. $\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{b_1 + b_2 + \cdots + b_n}{n} = 0$.

$\Rightarrow \frac{a_1 + a_2 + \cdots + a_n}{n} - a \to 0$ as $n \to \infty$

$\Rightarrow \frac{a_1 + a_2 + \cdots + a_n}{n} \to a$ as $n \to \infty$.

Exercise 2.

Prove that $\mathbb{R}$ is uncountable.

Method 1: Cantor's theorem: $(0,1)$ is uncountable. $(0,1) \in \mathbb{R} \Rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is uncountable

Method 2: Suppose $\mathbb{R}$ is Countable

Then $\mathbb{R} = \{x_1, x_2, x_3, \cdots\}$.

Choose a closed interval $[a_1, b_1]$ with $x_1 \notin [a_1, b_1]$

divide into 3 parts: $[a_1, \frac{2a_1+b_1}{3}]$, $[\frac{2a_1+b_1}{3}, \frac{a_1+2b_1}{3}]$, $[\frac{a_1+2b_1}{3}, b_1]$

At most two of them contains x_2 ⇒ at least one does not contain x_2, denote it $[a_2, b_2]$

divide $[a_2, b_2]$ into 3 parts.

At least one Subsequence does not Contain x_3

$\vdots$

$[a_{n+1}, b_{n+1}] \subseteq [a_n, b_n]$. $x_{n+1} \notin [a_n, b_n]$

$b_n - a_n = (b_1 - a_1)\frac{1}{3^{n-1}} \to 0$ as $n \to \infty$.

⇒ $\bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} [a_n, b_n] = \xi$

⇒ ξ is a real number, $\xi \notin \{x_1, \cdots\}$ ⇒ Contradiction.

Exercise 3.

If a sequence $\{x_n\}$ converges to a, then every subsequence $\{x_{n_k}\}$ also converges to a, that is,

$\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = a \Rightarrow \lim_{k\to\infty} x_{n_k} = a$.

$\lim_{n\to\infty} x_n = a \Leftrightarrow \forall \varepsilon > 0\ \exists N \in \mathbb{N}.\ n > N \Rightarrow |x_n - a| < \varepsilon$

Let $K \in \mathbb{N}$. $k > K \Rightarrow n_k > N \Rightarrow |x_{n_k} - a| < \varepsilon$

$\Rightarrow x_{n_k} \to a$ as $n \to \infty$

Corollary 1. If a sequence $\{x_n\}$ has two subsequences $\{x_{n_k}\}$ and $\{x_{m_k}\}$ that converge to different limits, then $\{x_n\}$ diverges.

Example 1. The sequence $\left\{\sin\frac{n\pi}{2}\right\}$ diverges.

for $n_k = 4k$. $x_{n_k} = 0$. $x_{n_k} \to 0$ as $n \to \infty$

for $m_k = \frac{1}{2}4k + 1$. $x_{m_k} = 1$. $x_{m_k} = 1$ as $n \to \infty$

⇒ Diverge

Exercise 4.

If $\{x_n\}$ is an unbounded sequence, then there exists a subsequence $\{x_{n_k}\}$ such that:

$$\lim_{k\to\infty} x_{n_k} = \infty.$$

x_n is an unbounded Sequence ⇒ $\exists\ n_1$, $x_{n_1} > 1$.

$\exists\ n_2 > n_1$. $x_{n_2} > 2$. $\cdots$ $\exists\ n_{k+1} > n_k$. $x_{n_{k+1}} > k+1$

⇒ $x_{n_k} \to \infty$ as $n_k \to \infty$